

The Asteroids; Or Minor Planets Between Mars and Jupiter.

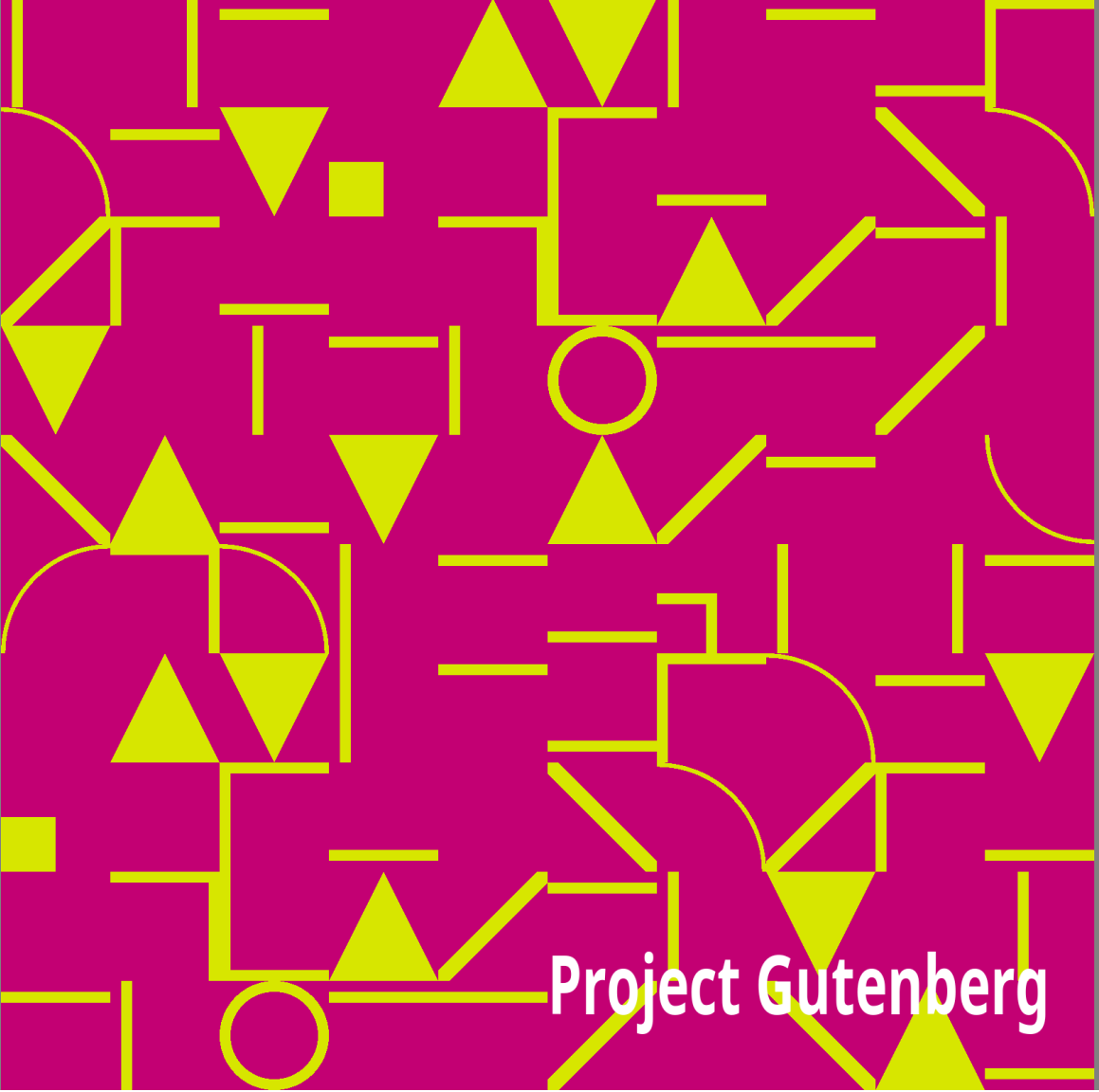
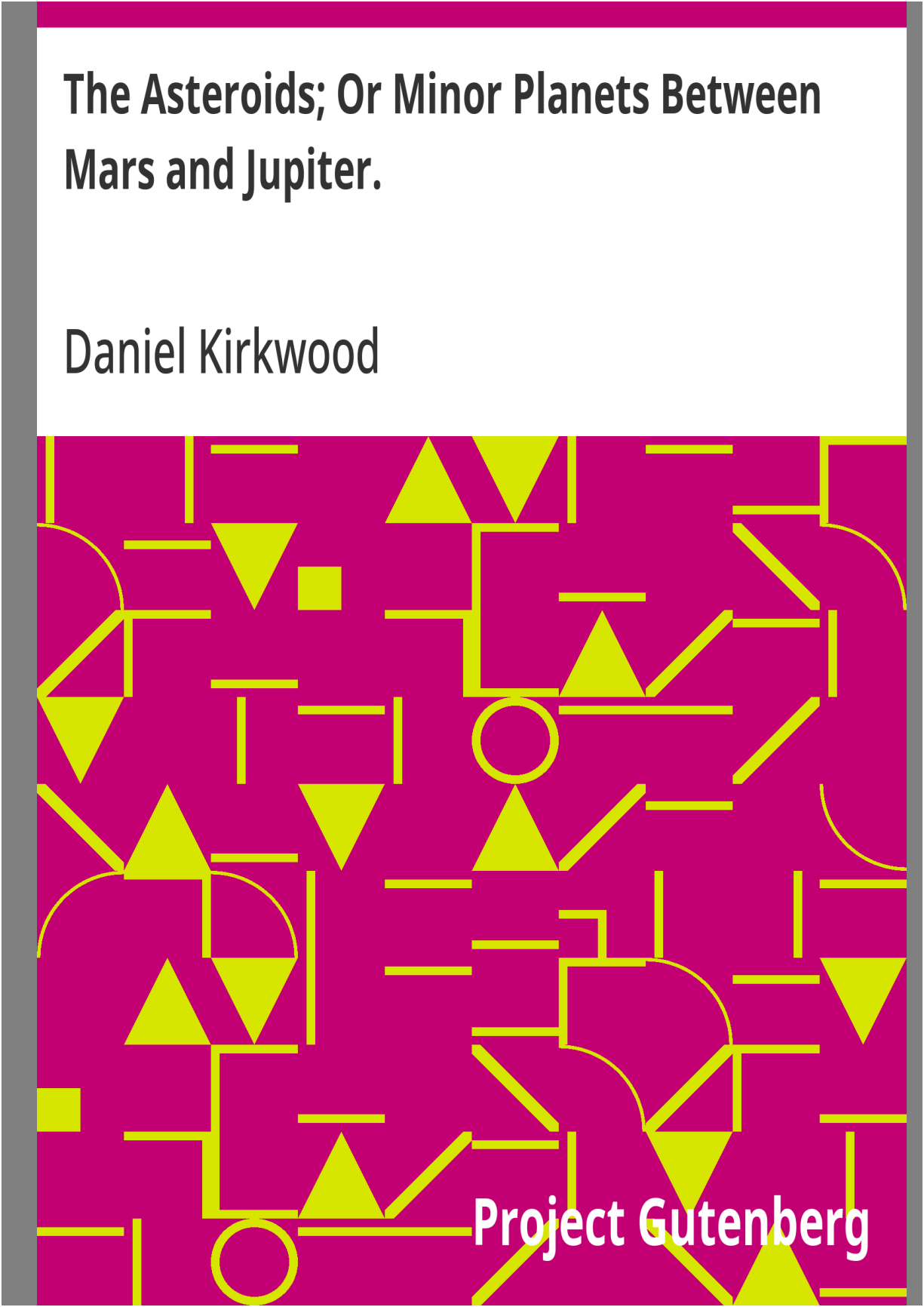
Daniel Kirkwood



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Every effort has been made to replicate this text as faithfully as possible, including non-standard spelling and punctuation. Some apparent typographical errors in the indices and names of asteroids in Tables I and II have been corrected.

**THE
ASTEROIDS,
OR
MINOR PLANETS**

BETWEEN MARS AND JUPITER.

BY
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PREFACE.

The rapid progress of discovery in the zone of minor planets, the anomalous forms and positions of their orbits, the small size as well as the great number of these telescopic bodies, and their peculiar relations to Jupiter, the massive planet next exterior,—all entitle this part of the system to more particular consideration than it has hitherto received. The following essay is designed, therefore, to supply an obvious want. Its results are given in some detail up to the date of publication. Part I. presents in a popular form the leading historical facts as to the discovery of Ceres, Pallas, Juno, Vesta, and Astræa; a tabular statement of the dates and places of discovery for the entire group; a list of the names of discoverers, with the number of minor planets detected by each; and a table of the principal elements so far as computed.

In Part II. this descriptive summary is followed by questions relating to the origin of the cluster; the elimination of members from particular parts; the eccentricities and inclinations of the orbits; and the relation of the zone to comets of short period. The elements are those given in the Paris *Annuaire* for 1887, or in recent numbers of the *Circular zum Berliner Astronomischen Jahrbuch*.

DANIEL KIRKWOOD.

BLOOMINGTON, INDIANA, November, 1887.

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PART I.

THE ASTEROIDS, OR MINOR PLANETS BETWEEN MARS AND JUPITER.

1. Introductory.

PLANETARY DISCOVERIES BEFORE THE ASTEROIDS WERE KNOWN.

The first observer who watched the skies with any degree of care could not fail to notice that while the greater number of stars maintained the same relative places, a few from night to night were ever changing their positions. The planetary character of Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, and Saturn was thus known before the dawn of history. The names, however, of those who first distinguished them as "wanderers" are hopelessly lost. Venus, the morning and evening star, was long regarded as two distinct bodies. The discovery that the change of aspect was due to a single planet's change of position is ascribed to Pythagoras.

At the beginning of the seventeenth century but six primary planets and one satellite were known as members of the solar system. Very few, even of the learned, had then accepted the theory of Copernicus; in fact, before the invention of the telescope the evidence in its favor was not absolutely conclusive. On the 7th of January, 1610, Galileo first saw the satellites of Jupiter. The bearing of this discovery on the theory of the universe was sufficiently obvious. Such was the prejudice, however, against the Copernican system that some of its opponents denied even the reality of Galileo's discovery. "Those satellites," said a Tuscan astronomer, "are invisible to the naked eye, and therefore can exercise no influence on the earth, and therefore would be useless, and therefore do not exist. Besides, the Jews and other ancient nations, as well as modern Europeans, have adopted the division of the week into *seven* days, and have named them from the seven planets; now, if we increase the number of planets this whole system falls to the ground."

No other secondary planet was discovered till March 25, 1655, when Titan, the largest satellite of Saturn, was detected by Huyghens. About two years later (December 7, 1657) the same astronomer discovered the true form of

Saturn's ring; and before the close of the century (1671-1684) four more satellites, Japetus, Rhea, Tethys, and Dione, were added to the Saturnian system by the elder Cassini. Our planetary system, therefore, as known at the close of the seventeenth century, consisted of six primary and ten secondary planets.

Nearly a century had elapsed from the date of Cassini's discovery of Dione, when, on the 13th of March, 1781, Sir William Herschel enlarged the dimensions of our system by the detection of a planet—Uranus—exterior to Saturn. A few years later (1787-1794) the same distinguished observer discovered the first and second satellites of Saturn, and also the four Uranian satellites. He was the only planet discoverer of the eighteenth century.

2. Discovery of the First Asteroids.

As long ago as the commencement of the seventeenth century the celebrated Kepler observed that the respective distances of the planets from the sun formed nearly a regular progression. The series, however, by which those distances were expressed required the interpolation of a term between Mars and Jupiter,—a fact which led the illustrious German to predict the discovery of a planet in that interval. This conjecture attracted but little attention till after the discovery of Uranus, whose distance was found to harmonize in a remarkable manner with Kepler's order of progression. Such a coincidence was of course regarded with considerable interest. Towards the close of the last century Professor Bode, who had given the subject much attention, published the law of distances which bears his name, but which, as he acknowledged, is due to Professor Titius. According to this formula the distances of the planets from Mercury's orbit form a geometrical series of which the ratio is two. In other words, if we reckon the distances of Venus, the earth, etc., from the orbit of Mercury, instead of from the sun, we find that—interpolating a term between Mars and Jupiter—the distance of any member of the system is very nearly half that of the next exterior. Baron De Zach, an enthusiastic astronomer, was greatly interested in Bode's empirical scheme, and undertook to determine the elements of the hypothetical planet. In 1800 a number of astronomers met at Lilienthal, organized an astronomical society, and assigned one twenty-fourth part of the zodiac to each of twenty-four observers, in order to detect, if possible, the unseen planet. When it is remembered that at this time no primary planet had been

discovered within the ancient limits of the solar system, that the object to be looked for was comparatively near us, and that the so-called law of distances was purely empirical, the prospect of success, it is evident, was extremely uncertain. How long the watch, if unsuccessful, might have been continued is doubtful. The object of research, however, was fortunately brought to light before the members of the astronomical association had fairly commenced their labors.^[1]

On the 1st of January, 1801, Professor Giuseppe Piazzi, of Palermo, noticed a star of the eighth magnitude, not indicated in Wollaston's catalogue. Subsequent observations soon revealed its planetary character, its mean distance corresponding very nearly with the calculations of De Zach. The discoverer called it Ceres Ferdinandea, in honor of his sovereign, the King of Naples. In this, however, he was not followed by astronomers, and the planet is now known by the name of Ceres alone. The discovery of this body was hailed by astronomers with the liveliest gratification as completing the harmony of the system. What, then, was their surprise when in the course of a few months this remarkable order was again interrupted! On the 28th of March, 1802, Dr. William Olbers, of Bremen, while examining the relative positions of the small stars along the path of Ceres, in order to find that planet with the greater facility, noticed a star of the seventh or eighth magnitude, forming with two others an equilateral triangle where he was certain no such configuration existed a few months before. In the course of a few hours its motion was perceptible, and on the following night it had very sensibly changed its position with respect to the neighboring stars. Another planet was therefore detected, and Dr. Olbers immediately communicated his discovery to Professor Bode and Baron De Zach. In his letter to the former he suggested Pallas as the name of the new member of the system,—a name which was at once adopted. Its orbit, which was soon computed by Gauss, was found to present several striking anomalies. The inclination of its plane to that of the ecliptic was nearly thirty-five degrees,—an amount of deviation altogether extraordinary. The eccentricity also was greater than in the case of any of the old planets. These peculiarities, together with the fact that the mean distances of Ceres and Pallas were nearly the same, and that their orbits approached very near each other at the intersection of their planes, suggested the hypothesis that they are fragments of a single original planet, which, at a very remote epoch, was disrupted by some mysterious

convulsion. This theory will be considered when we come to discuss the tabulated elements of the minor planets now known.

For the convenience of astronomers, Professor Harding, of Lilienthal, undertook the construction of charts of all the small stars near the orbits of Ceres and Pallas. On the evening of September 1, 1804, while engaged in observations for this purpose, he noticed a star of the eighth magnitude not mentioned in the great catalogue of Lalande. This proved to be a third member of the group of asteroids. The discovery was first announced to Dr. Olbers, who observed the planet at Bremen on the evening of September 7.

Before Ceres had been generally adopted by astronomers as the name of the first asteroid, Laplace had expressed a preference for Juno. This, however, the discoverer was unwilling to accept. Mr. Harding, like Laplace, deeming it appropriate to place Juno near Jupiter, selected the name for the third minor planet, which is accordingly known by this designation.

Juno is distinguished among the first asteroids by the great eccentricity of its orbit, amounting to more than 0.25. Its least and its greatest distances from the sun are therefore to each other very nearly in the ratio of three to five. The planet consequently receives nearly three times as much light and heat in perihelion as in aphelion. It follows, also, that the half of the orbit nearest the sun is described in about eighteen months, while the remainder, or more distant half, is not passed over in much less than three years. Schroeter noticed a variation in the light of Juno, which he supposed to be produced by an axial rotation in about twenty-seven hours.

The fact that Juno was discovered not far from the point at which the orbit of Pallas approaches very near that of Ceres, was considered a strong confirmation of the hypothesis that the asteroids were produced by the explosion of a large planet; for in case this hypothesis be founded in truth, it is evident that whatever may have been the forms of the various orbits assumed by the fragments, they must all return to the point of separation. In order, therefore, to detect other members of the group, Dr. Olbers undertook a systematic examination of the two opposite regions of the heavens through which they must pass. This search was prosecuted with great industry and perseverance till ultimately crowned with success. On the 29th of March, 1807, while sweeping over one of those regions through which the orbits of the known asteroids passed, a star of the sixth magnitude was observed

where none had been seen at previous examinations. Its planetary character, which was immediately suspected, was confirmed by observation, its motion being detected on the very evening of its discovery. This fortunate result afforded the first instance of the discovery of two primary planets by the same observer.

The astronomer Gauss having been requested to name the new planet, fixed upon Vesta, a name universally accepted. Though the brightest of the asteroids, its apparent diameter is too small to be accurately determined, and hence its real magnitude is not well ascertained. Professor Harrington, of Ann Arbor, has estimated the diameter at five hundred and twenty miles. According to others, however, it does not exceed three hundred. If the latter be correct, the volume is about $1/20000$ that of the earth. It is remarkable that notwithstanding its diminutive size it may be seen under favorable circumstances by the naked eye.

Encouraged by the discovery of Vesta (which he regarded as almost a demonstration of his favorite theory), Dr. Olbers continued his systematic search for other planetary fragments. Not meeting, however, with further success, he relinquished his observations in 1816. His failure, it may here be remarked, was doubtless owing to the fact that his examination was limited to stars of the seventh and eighth magnitudes.

The search for new planets was next resumed about 1831, by Herr Hencke, of Driessen. With a zeal and perseverance worthy of all praise, this amateur astronomer employed himself in a strict examination of the heavens represented by the Maps of the Berlin Academy. These maps extend fifteen degrees on each side of the equator, and contain all stars down to the ninth magnitude and many of the tenth. Dr. Hencke rendered some of these charts still more complete by the insertion of smaller stars; or rather, "made for himself special charts of particular districts." On the evening of December 8, 1845, he observed a star of the ninth magnitude where none had been previously seen, as he knew from the fact that it was neither found on his own chart nor given on that of the Academy. On the next morning he wrote to Professors Encke and Schumacher informing them of his supposed discovery. "It is very improbable," he remarked in his letter to the latter, "that this should prove to be merely a variable star, since in my former observations of this region, which have been continued for many years, I

have never detected the slightest trace of it." The new star was soon seen at the principal observatories of Europe, and its planetary character satisfactorily established. The selection of a name was left by the discoverer to Professor Encke, who chose that of Astræa.

The facts in regard to the very numerous subsequent discoveries may best be presented in a tabular form.

TABLE I.

The Asteroids in the Order of their Discovery.

Asteroids.	Date of Discovery.	Name of Discoverer.	Place of Discovery.
1. Ceres	1801, Jan. 1	Piazzi	Palermo
2. Pallas	1802, Mar. 28	Olbers	Bremen
3. Juno	1804, Sept. 1	Harding	Lilienthal
4. Vesta	1807, Mar. 29	Olbers	Bremen
5. Astræa	1845, Dec. 8	Hencke	Driessen
6. Hebe	1847, July 1	Hencke	Driessen
7. Iris	1847, Aug. 14	Hind	London
8. Flora	1847, Oct. 18	Hind	London
9. Metis	1848, Apr. 26	Graham	Markree

10. Hygeia	1849, Apr. 12	De Gasparis	Naples
11. Parthenope	1850, May 11	De Gasparis	Naples
12. Victoria	1850, Sept. 13	Hind	London
13. Egeria	1850, Nov. 2	De Gasparis	Naples
14. Irene	1851, May 19	Hind	London
15. Eunomia	1851, July 29	De Gasparis	Naples
16. Psyche	1852, Mar. 17	De Gasparis	Naples
17. Thetis	1852, Apr. 17	Luther	Bilk
18. Melpomene	1852, June 24	Hind	London
19. Fortuna	1852, Aug. 22	Hind	London
20. Massalia	1852, Sept. 19	De Gasparis	Naples
21. Lutetia	1852, Nov. 15	Goldschmidt	Paris
22. Calliope	1852, Nov. 16	Hind	London

23. Thalia	1852, Dec. 15	Hind	London
24. Themis	1853, Apr. 5	De Gasparis	Naples
25. Phocea	1853, Apr. 6	Chacornac	Marseilles
26. Proserpine	1853, May 5	Luther	Bilk
27. Euterpe	1853, Nov. 8	Hind	London
28. Bellona	1854, Mar. 1	Luther	Bilk
29. Amphitrite	1854, Mar. 1	Marth	London
30. Urania	1854, July 22	Hind	London
31. Euphrosyne	1854, Sept. 1	Ferguson	Washington
32. Pomona	1854, Oct. 26	Goldschmidt	Paris
33. Polyhymnia	1854, Oct. 28	Chacornac	Paris
34. Circe	1855, Apr. 6	Chacornac	Paris
35. Leucothea	1855, Apr. 19	Luther	Bilk
36. Atalanta	1855, Oct. 5	Goldschmidt	Paris
37. Fides	1855, Oct. 5	Luther	Bilk
38. Leda	1856, Jan. 12	Chacornac	Paris
39. Lætitia	1856, Feb. 8	Chacornac	Paris

40. Harmonia	1856, Mar. 31	Goldschmidt	Paris
41. Daphne	1856, May 22	Goldschmidt	Paris
42. Isis	1856, May 23	Pogson	Oxford
43. Ariadne	1857, Apr. 15	Pogson	Oxford
44. Nysa	1857, May 27	Goldschmidt	Paris
45. Eugenia	1857, June 27	Goldschmidt	Paris
46. Hestia	1857, Aug. 16	Pogson	Oxford
47. Aglaia	1857, Sept. 15	Luther	Bilk
48. Doris	1857, Sept. 19	Goldschmidt	Paris
49. Pales	1857, Sept. 19	Goldschmidt	Paris
50. Virginia	1857, Oct. 4	Ferguson	Washington
51. Nemausa	1858, Jan. 22	Laurent	Nismes
52. Europa	1858, Feb. 4	Goldschmidt	Paris
53. Calypso	1858, Apr. 4	Luther	Bilk

54. Alexandra	1858, Sept. 10	Goldschmidt	Paris
55. Pandora	1858, Sept. 10	Searle	Albany
56. Melete	1857, Sept. 9	Goldschmidt	Paris
57. Mnemosyne	1859, Sept. 22	Luther	Bilk
58. Concordia	1860, Mar. 24	Luther	Bilk
59. Olympia	1860, Sept. 12	Chacornac	Paris
60. Echo	1860, Sept. 16	Ferguson	Washington
61. Danaë	1860, Sept. 9	Goldschmidt	Paris
62. Erato	1860, Sept. 14	Foerster and Lesser	Berlin
63. Ausonia	1861, Feb. 10	De Gasparis	Naples
64. Angelina	1861, Mar. 4	Tempel	Marseilles
65. Maximiliana	1861, Mar. 8	Tempel	Marseilles
66. Maia	1861, Apr. 9	Tuttle	Cambridge, U.S.
67. Asia	1861, Apr. 17	Pogson	Madras

68. Leto	1861, Apr. 29	Luther	Bilk
69. Hesperia	1861, Apr. 29	Schiaparelli	Milan
70. Panopea	1861, May 5	Goldschmidt	Paris
71. Niobe	1861, Aug. 13	Luther	Bilk
72. Feronia	1862, May 29	Peters and Safford	Clinton
73. Clytie	1862, Apr. 7	Tuttle	Cambridge
74. Galatea	1862, Aug. 29	Tempel	Marseilles
75. Eurydice	1862, Sept. 22	Peters	Clinton
76. Freia	1862, Oct. 21	D'Arrest	Copenhagen
77. Frigga	1862, Nov. 12	Peters	Clinton
78. Diana	1863, Mar. 15	Luther	Bilk
79. Eurynome	1863, Sept. 14	Watson	Ann Arbor
80. Sappho	1864, May 2	Pogson	Madras
81. Terpsichore	1864, Sept. 30	Tempel	Marseilles

82. Alcmene	1864, Nov. 27	Luther	Bilk
83. Beatrix	1865, Apr. 26	De Gasparis	Naples
84. Clio	1865, Aug. 25	Luther	Bilk
85. Io	1865, Sept. 19	Peters	Clinton
86. Semele	1866, Jan. 14	Tietjen	Berlin
87. Sylvia	1866, May 16	Pogson	Madras
88. Thisbe	1866, June 15	Peters	Clinton
89. Julia	1866, Aug. 6	Stephan	Marseilles
90. Antiope	1866, Oct. 1	Luther	Bilk
91. Ægina	1866, Nov. 4	Borelly	Marseilles
92. Undina	1867, July 7	Peters	Clinton
93. Minerva	1867, Aug. 24	Watson	Ann Arbor
94. Aurora	1867, Sept. 6	Watson	Ann Arbor
95. Arethusa	1867, Nov. 24	Luther	Bilk
96. Ægle	1868, Feb. 17	Coggia	Marseilles

97. Clotho	1868, Feb. 17	Coggia	Marseilles
98. Ianthe	1868, Apr. 18	Peters	Clinton
99. Dike	1868, May 28	Borelly	Marseilles
100. Hecate	1868, July 11	Watson	Ann Arbor
101. Helena	1868, Aug. 15	Watson	Ann Arbor
102. Miriam	1868, Aug. 22	Peters	Clinton
103. Hera	1868, Sept. 7	Watson	Ann Arbor
104. Clymene	1868, Sept. 13	Watson	Ann Arbor
105. Artemis	1868, Sept. 16	Watson	Ann Arbor
106. Dione	1868, Oct. 10	Watson	Ann Arbor
107. Camilla	1868, Nov. 17	Pogson	Madras
108. Hecuba	1869, Apr. 2	Luther	Bilk
109. Felicitas	1869, Oct. 9	Peters	Clinton
110. Lydia	1870, Apr. 19	Borelly	Marseilles

111. Ate	1870, Aug. 14	Peters	Clinton
112. Iphigenia	1870, Sept. 19	Peters	Clinton
113. Amalthea	1871, Mar. 12	Luther	Bilk
114. Cassandra	1871, July 23	Peters	Clinton
115. Thyra	1871, Aug. 6	Watson	Ann Arbor
116. Sirona	1871, Sept. 8	Peters	Clinton
117. Lomia	1871, Sept. 12	Borelly	Marseilles
118. Peitho	1872, Mar. 15	Luther	Bilk
119. Althea	1872, Apr. 3	Watson	Ann Arbor
120. Lachesis	1872, Apr. 10	Borelly	Marseilles
121. Hermione	1872, May 12	Watson	Ann Arbor
122. Gerda	1872, July 31	Peters	Clinton
123. Brunhilda	1872, July 31	Peters	Clinton
124. Alceste	1872, Aug. 23	Peters	Clinton
125. Liberatrix	1872, Sept. 11	Prosper Henry	Paris

126. Velleda	1872, Nov. 5	Paul Henry	Paris
127. Johanna	1872, Nov. 5	Prosper Henry	Paris
128. Nemesis	1872, Nov. 25	Watson	Ann Arbor
129. Antigone	1873, Feb. 5	Peters	Clinton
130. Electra	1873, Feb. 17	Peters	Clinton
131. Vala	1873, May 24	Peters	Clinton
132. Æthra	1873, June 13	Watson	Ann Arbor
133. Cyrene	1873, Aug. 16	Watson	Ann Arbor
134. Sophrosyne	1873, Sept. 27	Luther	Bilk
135. Hertha	1874, Feb. 18	Peters	Clinton
136. Austria	1874, Mar. 18	Palisa	Pola
137. Melibœa	1874, Apr. 21	Palisa	Pola
138. Tolosa	1874, May 19	Perrotin	Toulouse
139. Juewa	1874, Oct. 10	Watson	Pekin

140. Siwa	1874, Oct. 13	Palisa	Pola
141. Lumen	1875, Jan. 13	Paul Henry	Paris
142. Polana	1875, Jan. 28	Palisa	Pola
143. Adria	1875, Feb. 23	Palisa	Pola
144. Vibilia	1875, June 3	Peters	Clinton
145. Adeona	1875, June 3	Peters	Clinton
146. Lucina	1875, June 8	Borelly	Marseilles
147. Protogenea	1875, July 10	Schulhof	Vienna
148. Gallia	1875, Aug. 7	Prosper Henry	Paris
149. Medusa	1875, Sept. 21	Perrotin	Toulouse
150. Nuwa	1875, Oct. 18	Watson	Ann Arbor
151. Abundantia	1875, Nov. 1	Palisa	Pola
152. Atala	1875, Nov. 2	Paul Henry	Paris
153. Hilda	1875, Nov. 2	Palisa	Pola
154. Bertha	1875, Nov. 4	Prosper Henry	Paris
155. Scylla	1875, Nov. 8	Palisa	Pola
156. Xantippe	1875, Nov. 22	Palisa	Pola

157. Dejanira	1875, Dec. 1	Borelly	Marseilles
158. Coronis	1876, Jan. 4	Knorre	Berlin
159. Æmilia	1876, Jan. 26	Paul Henry	Paris
160. Una	1876, Feb. 20	Peters	Clinton
161. Athor	1876, Apr. 19	Watson	Ann Arbor
162. Laurentia	1876, Apr. 21	Prosper Henry	Paris
163. Erigone	1876, Apr. 26	Perrotin	Toulouse
164. Eva	1876, July 12	Paul Henry	Paris
165. Loreley	1876, Aug. 9	Peters	Clinton
166. Rhodope	1876, Aug. 15	Peters	Clinton
167. Urda	1876, Aug. 28	Peters	Clinton
168. Sibylla	1876, Sept. 27	Watson	Ann Arbor
169. Zelia	1876, Sept. 28	Prosper Henry	Paris
170. Maria	1877, Jan. 10	Perrotin	Toulouse
171. Ophelia	1877, Jan. 13	Borelly	Marseilles

172. Baucis	1877, Feb. 5	Borelly	Marseilles
173. Ino	1877, Aug. 1	Borelly	Marseilles
174. Phædra	1877, Sept. 2	Watson	Ann Arbor
175. Andromache	1877, Oct. 1	Watson	Ann Arbor
176. Idunna	1877, Oct. 14	Peters	Clinton
177. Irma	1877, Nov. 5	Paul Henry	Paris
178. Belisana	1877, Nov. 6	Palisa	Pola
179. Clytemnestra	1877, Nov. 11	Watson	Ann Arbor
180. Garumna	1878, Jan. 29	Perrotin	Toulouse
181. Eucharis	1878, Feb. 2	Cottenot	Marseilles
182. Elsa	1878, Feb. 7	Palisa	Pola
183. Istria	1878, Feb. 8	Palisa	Pola
184. Deiopea	1878, Feb. 28	Palisa	Pola
185. Eunice	1878, Mar. 1	Peters	Clinton
186. Celuta	1878, Apr. 6	Prosper Henry	Paris
187. Lamberta	1878, Apr. 11	Coggia	Marseilles
188. Menippe	1878, June 18	Peters	Clinton

189. Phthia	1878, Sept. 9	Peters	Clinton
190. Ismene	1878, Sept. 22	Peters	Clinton
191. Kolga	1878, Sept. 30	Peters	Clinton
192. Nausicaa	1879, Feb. 17	Palisa	Pola
193. Ambrosia	1879, Feb. 28	Coggia	Marseilles
194. Procne	1879, Mar. 21	Peters	Clinton
195. Euryclea	1879, Apr. 22	Palisa	Pola
196. Philomela	1879, May 14	Peters	Clinton
197. Arete	1879, May 21	Palisa	Pola
198. Ampella	1879, June 13	Borelly	Marseilles
199. Byblis	1879, July 9	Peters	Clinton
200. Dynamene	1879, July 27	Peters	Clinton
201. Penelope	1879, Aug. 7	Palisa	Pola
202. Chryseis	1879, Sept. 11	Peters	Clinton

203. Pompeia	1879, Sept. 25	Peters	Clinton
204. Callisto	1879, Oct. 8	Palisa	Pola
205. Martha	1879, Oct. 13	Palisa	Pola
206. Hersilia	1879, Oct. 13	Peters	Clinton
207. Hedda	1879, Oct. 17	Palisa	Pola
208. Lachrymosa	1879, Oct. 21	Palisa	Pola
209. Dido	1879, Oct. 22	Peters	Clinton
210. Isabella	1879, Nov. 12	Palisa	Pola
211. Isolda	1879, Dec. 10	Palisa	Pola
212. Medea	1880, Feb. 6	Palisa	Pola
213. Lilæa	1880, Feb. 16	Peters	Clinton
214. Aschera	1880, Feb. 26	Palisa	Pola
215. CEnone	1880, Apr. 7	Knorre	Berlin
216. Cleopatra	1880, Apr. 10	Palisa	Pola

217. Eudora	1880, Aug. 30	Coggia	Marseilles
218. Bianca	1880, Sept. 4	Palisa	Pola
219. Thusnelda	1880, Sept. 20	Palisa	Pola
220. Stephania	1881, May 19	Palisa	Vienna
221. Eos	1882, Jan. 18	Palisa	Vienna
222. Lucia	1882, Feb. 9	Palisa	Vienna
223. Rosa	1882, Mar. 9	Palisa	Vienna
224. Oceana	1882, Mar. 30	Palisa	Vienna
225. Henrietta	1882, Apr. 19	Palisa	Vienna
226. Weringia	1882, July 19	Palisa	Vienna
227. Philosophia	1882, Aug. 12	Paul Henry	Paris
228. Agathe	1882, Aug. 19	Palisa	Vienna
229. Adelinda	1882, Aug. 22	Palisa	Vienna
230. Athamantis	1882, Sept. 3	De Ball	Bothcamp
231. Vindobona	1882, Sept. 10	Palisa	Vienna

232. Russia	1883, Jan. 31	Palisa	Vienna
233. Asterope	1883, May 11	Borelly	Marseilles
234. Barbara	1883, Aug. 13	Peters	Clinton
235. Caroline	1883, Nov. 29	Palisa	Vienna
236. Honoria	1884, Apr. 26	Palisa	Vienna
237. Cœlestina	1884, June 27	Palisa	Vienna
238. Hypatia	1884, July 1	Knorre	Berlin
239. Adrastea	1884, Aug. 18	Palisa	Vienna
240. Vanadis	1884, Aug. 27	Borelly	Marseilles
241. Germania	1884, Sept. 12	Luther	Dusseldorf
242. Kriemhild	1884, Sept. 22	Palisa	Vienna
243. Ida	1884, Sept. 29	Palisa	Vienna
244. Sita	1884, Oct. 14	Palisa	Vienna
245. Vera	1885, Feb. 6	Pogson	Madras

246. Asporina	1885, Mar. 6	Borelly	Marseilles
247. Eukrate	1885, Mar. 14	Luther	Dusseldorf
248. Lameia	1885, June 5	Palisa	Vienna
249. Ilse	1885, Aug. 17	Peters	Clinton
250. Bettina	1885, Sept. 3	Palisa	Vienna
251. Sophia	1885, Oct. 4	Palisa	Vienna
252. Clementina	1885, Oct. 27	Perrotin	Nice
253. Mathilde	1885, Nov. 12	Palisa	Vienna
254. Augusta	1886, Mar. 31	Palisa	Vienna
255. Oppavia	1886, Mar. 31	Palisa	Vienna
256. Walpurga	1886, Apr. 3	Palisa	Vienna
257. Silesia	1886, Apr. 5	Palisa	Vienna
258. Tyche	1886, May 4	Luther	Dusseldorf
259. Aletheia	1886, June 28	Peters	Clinton
260. Huberta	1886, Oct. 3	Palisa	Vienna

261. Prymno	1886, Oct. 31	Peters	Clinton
262. Valda	1886, Nov. 3	Palisa	Vienna
263. Dresda	1886, Nov. 3	Palisa	Vienna
264. Libussa	1886, Dec. 17	Peters	Clinton
265. Anna	1887, Feb. 25	Palisa	Vienna
266. Aline	1887, May 17	Palisa	Vienna
267. Tirza	1887, May 27	Charlois	Nice
268.	1887, June 9	Borelly	Marseilles
269.	1887, Sept. 21	Palisa	Vienna
270.	1887, Oct. 8	Peters	Clinton
271.	1887, Oct. 16	Knorre	Berlin

3. Remarks on Table I.

The numbers discovered by the thirty-five observers are respectively as follows:

Palisa	60
Peters	47
Luther	23

Watson	22
Borelly	15
Goldschmidt	14
Hind	10
De Gasparis	9
Pogson	8
Paul Henry	7
Prosper Henry	7
Chacornac	6
Perrotin	6
Coggia	5
Knorre	4
Tempel	4
Ferguson	3
Olbers	2
Hencke	2
Tuttle	2
Foerster (with Lesser)	1
Safford (with Peters)	1
and Messrs. Charlois, Cottenot, D'Arrest, De Ball, Graham, Harding, Laurent, Piazzzi, Schiaparelli, Schulhof, Stephan, Searle, and Tietjen, each	1

Before arrangements had been made for the telegraphic transmission of discoveries between Europe and America, or even between the observatories of Europe, the same planet was sometimes independently discovered by different observers. For example, Virginia was found by Ferguson, at Washington, on October 4, 1857, and by Luther, at Bilk, fifteen days later. In all cases, however, credit has been given to the first observer.

Hersilia, the two hundred and sixth of the group, was lost before sufficient observations were obtained for determining its elements. It was not rediscovered till December 14, 1884. Menippe, the one hundred and eighty-eighth, was also lost soon after its discovery in 1878. It has not been seen for

more than nine years, and considerable uncertainty attaches to its estimated elements.

Of the two hundred and seventy-one members now known (1887), one hundred and ninety-one have been discovered in Europe, seventy-four in America, and six in Asia. The years of most successful search, together with the number discovered in each, were:

Asteroids.	
1879	20
1875	17
1868	12
1878	12

And six has been the average yearly number since the commencement of renewed effort in 1845. All the larger members of the group have, doubtless, been discovered. It seems not improbable, however, that an indefinite number of very small bodies belonging to the zone remain to be found. The process of discovery is becoming more difficult as the known number increases. The astronomer, for instance, who may discover number two hundred and seventy-two must know the simultaneous positions of the two hundred and seventy-one previously detected before he can decide whether he has picked up a new planet or merely rediscovered an old one. The numbers discovered in the several months are as follows:

January	13
February	23
March	19
April	35
May	21
June	13
July	14
August	28
September	46
October	28
November	26

This obvious disparity is readily explained. The weather is favorable for night watching in April and September; the winter months are too cold for continuous observations; and the small numbers in June and July may be referred to the shortness of the nights.

4. Mode of Discovery.

The astronomer who would undertake the search for new asteroids must supply himself with star-charts extending some considerable distance on each side of the ecliptic, and containing all telescopic stars down to the thirteenth or fourteenth magnitude. The detection of a star not found in the chart of a particular section will indicate its motion, and hence its planetary character. The construction of such charts has been a principal object in the labors of Dr. Peters, at Clinton, New York. In fact, his discovery of minor planets has in most instances been merely an incidental result of his larger and more important work.

NAMES AND SYMBOLS.

The fact that the names of female deities in the Greek and Roman mythologies had been given to the first asteroids suggested a similar course in the selection of names after the new epoch of discovery in 1845. While conformity to this rule has been the general aim of discoverers, the departures from it have been increasingly numerous. The twelfth asteroid, discovered in London, was named Victoria, in honor of the reigning sovereign; the twentieth and twenty-fifth, detected at Marseilles,^[2] received names indicative of the place of their discovery; Lutetia, the first found at Paris, received its name for a similar purpose; the fifty-fourth was named Alexandra, for Alexander von Humboldt; the sixty-seventh, found by Pogson at Madras, was named Asia, to commemorate the fact that it was the first discovered on that continent. We find, also, Julia, Bertha, Xantippe, Zelia, Maria, Isabella, Martha, Dido, Cleopatra, Barbara, Ida, Augusta, and Anna. Why these were selected we will not stop to inquire.

As the number of asteroids increased it was found inconvenient to designate them individually by particular signs, as in the case of the old planets. In 1849, Dr. B. A. Gould proposed to represent them by the numbers expressing their order of discovery enclosed in a small circle. This method was at once very generally adopted.

5. Magnitudes of the Asteroids.

The apparent diameter of the largest is less than one-second of arc. They are all too small, therefore, to be accurately measured by astronomical instruments. From photometric observations, however, Argelander,^[3] Stone,^[4] and Pickering^[5] have formed estimates of the diameters, the results giving probably close approximations to the true magnitudes. According to these estimates the diameter of the largest, Vesta, is about three hundred miles, that of Ceres about two hundred, and those of Pallas and Juno between one and two hundred. The diameters of about thirty are between fifty and one hundred miles, and those of all others less than fifty; the estimates for Menippe and Eva giving twelve and thirteen miles respectively. The diameter of the former is to that of the earth as one to six hundred and sixty-four; and since spheres are to each other as the cubes of their diameters, it would require two hundred and ninety millions of such asteroids to form a planet as large as our globe. In other words, if the earth be represented by a sphere one foot in diameter, the magnitude of Menippe on the same scale would be that of a sand particle whose diameter is one fifty-fifth of an inch. Its surface contains about four hundred and forty square miles,—an area equal to a county twenty-one miles square. The surface attractions of two planets having the same density are to each other as their diameters. A body, therefore, weighing two hundred pounds at the earth's surface would on the surface of the asteroid weigh less than five ounces. At the earth's surface a weight falls sixteen feet the first second, at the surface of Menippe it would fall about one-fourth of an inch. A person might leap from its surface to a height of several hundred feet, in which case he could not return in much less than an hour. "But of such speculations," Sir John Herschel remarks, "there is no end."

The number of these planetules between the orbits of Mars and Jupiter in all probability can never be known. It was estimated by Leverrier that the

quantity of matter contained in the group could not be greater than one-fourth of the earth's mass. But this would be equal to five thousand planets, each as large as Vesta, to seventy-two millions as large as Menippe, or to four thousand millions of five miles in diameter. In short, the existence of an indefinite number too small for detection by the most powerful glasses is by no means improbable. The more we study this wonderful section of the solar system, the more mystery seems to envelop its origin and constitution.

6. The Orbits of the Asteroids.

The form, magnitude, and position of a planet's orbit are determined by the following elements:

1. The semi-axis major, or mean distance, denoted by the symbol a .
2. The eccentricity, e .
3. The longitude of the perihelion, π .
4. The longitude of the ascending node, Ω .
5. The inclination, or the angle contained between the plane of the orbit and that of the ecliptic, i .

And in order to compute a planet's place in its orbit for any given time we must also know

6. Its period, P , and
7. Its mean longitude, l , at a given epoch.

These elements, except the last, are given for all the asteroids, so far as known, in Table II. In column first the number denoting the order of discovery is attached to each name.

TABLE II.

Elements of the Asteroids.

Name	a	P	e	π	Ω	i
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149. Medusa	2.1327	1137.7d	0.1194	246 ° 37 ,	342 ° 13 ,	1° 6′
244. Sita	2.1765	1172.8	0.1370	13 8	208 37	2 50
228. Agathe	2.2009	1192.6	0.2405	329 23	313 18	2 33
8. Flora	2.2014	1193.3	0.1567	32 54	110 18	5 53
43. Ariadne	2.2033	1194.5	0.1671	277 58	264 35	3 28
254. Augusta	2.2060	1196.8	0.1227	260 47	28 9	4 36
72. Feronia	2.2661	1246.0	0.1198	307 58	207 49	5 24
40. Harmonia	2.2673	1247.0	0.0466	0 54	93 35	4 16
207. Hedda	2.2839	1260.7	0.0301	217 2	28 51	3 49
136. Austria	2.2863	1262.7	0.0849	316 6	186 7	9 33
18. Melpomene	2.2956	1270.4	0.2177	15 6	150 4	10 9
80. Sappho	2.2962	1270.9	0.2001	355 18	218 44	8 37

261. Prymno	2.3062	1278.4	0.0794	179 35	96 33	3 38
12. Victoria	2.3342	1302.7	0.2189	301 39	235 35	8 23
27. Euterpe	2.3472	1313.5	0.1739	87 59	93 51	1 36
219. Thusnelda	2.3542	1319.4	0.2247	340 34	200 44	10 47
163. Erigone	2.3560	1320.9	0.1567	93 46	159 2	4 42
169. Zelia	2.3577	1322.3	0.1313	326 20	354 38	5 31
4. Vesta	2.3616	1325.6	0.0884	250 57	103 29	7 8
186. Celuta	2.3623	1326.2	0.1512	327 24	14 34	13 6
84. Clio	2.3629	1326.7	0.2360	339 20	327 28	9 22
51. Nemausa	2.3652	1328.6	0.0672	174 43	175 52	9 57
220. Stephania	2.3666	1329.8	0.2653	332 53	258 24	7 35
30. Urania	2.3667	1329.9	0.1266	31 46	308 12	2 6
105. Artemis	2.3744	1336.4	0.1749	242 38	188 3	21 31

113. Amalthea	2.3761	1337.8	0.0874	198 44	123 11	5 2
115. Thyra	2.3791	1340.3	0.1939	43 2	309 5	11 35
161. Athor	2.3792	1340.5	0.1389	310 40	18 27	9 3
172. Baucis	2.3794	1340.6	0.1139	329 23	331 50	10 2
249. Ilse	2.3795	1340.6	0.2195	14 17	334 49	9 40
230. Athamantis	2.3842	1344.6	0.0615	17 31	239 33	9 26
7. Iris	2.3862	1346.4	0.2308	41 23	259 48	5 28
9. Metis	2.3866	1346.7	0.1233	71 4	68 32	5 36
234. Barbara	2.3873	1347.3	0.2440	333 26	144 9	15 22
60. Echo	2.3934	1352.4	0.1838	98 36	192 5	3 35
63. Ausonia	2.3979	1356.3	0.1239	270 25	337 58	5 48
25. Phoea	2.4005	1358.5	0.2553	302 48	208 27	21 35
192. Nausicaa	2.4014	1359.3	0.2413	343 19	160 46	6 50

20. Massalia	2.4024	1365.8	0.1429	99 7	206 36	0 41
265. Anna	2.4096	1366.2	0.2628	226 18	335 26	25 24
182. Elsa	2.4157	1371.4	0.1852	51 52	106 30	2 0
142. Polana	2.4194	1374.5	0.1322	219 54	317 34	2 14
67. Asia	2.4204	1375.4	0.1866	306 35	202 47	5 59
44. Nysa	2.4223	1377.0	0.1507	111 57	131 11	3 42
6. Hebe	2.4254	1379.3	0.2034	15 16	138 43	10 47
83. Beatrix	2.4301	1383.6	0.0859	191 46	27 32	5 0
135. Hertha	2.4303	1383.8	0.2037	320 11	344 3	2 19
131. Vala	2.4318	1385.1	0.0683	222 50	65 15	4 58
112. Iphigenia	2.4335	1386.6	0.1282	338 9	324 3	2 37
21. Lutetia	2.4354	1388.2	0.1621	327 4	80 28	3 5
118. Peitho	2.4384	1390.8	0.1608	77 36	47 30	7 48

126. Velleda	2.4399	1392.1	0.1061	347 46	23 7	2 56
42. Isis	2.4401	1392.2	0.2256	317 58	84 28	8 35
19. Fortuna	2.4415	1394.4	0.1594	31 3	211 27	1 33
79. Eurynome	2.4436	1395.2	0.1945	44 22	206 44	4 37
138. Tolosa	2.4492	1400.0	0.1623	311 39	54 52	3 14
189. Phthia	2.4505	1401.1	0.0356	6 50	203 22	5 10
11. Parthenope	2.4529	1403.2	0.0994	318 2	125 11	4 37
178. Belisana	2.4583	1407.8	0.1266	278 0	50 17	2 5
198. Ampella	2.4595	1408.9	0.2266	354 46	268 45	9 20
248. Lameia	2.4714	1419.1	0.0656	248 40	246 34	4 1
17. Thetis	2.4726	1420.1	0.1293	261 37	125 24	5 36
46. Hestia	2.5265	1466.8	0.1642	354 14	181 31	2 17
89. Julia	2.5510	1488.2	0.1805	353 13	311 42	16 11

232. Russia	2.5522	1489.3	0.1754	200 25	152 30	6 4
29. Amphitrite	2.5545	1491.3	0.0742	56 23	356 41	6 7
170. Maria	2.5549	1491.7	0.0639	95 47	301 20	14 23
262. Valda	2.5635	1496.4	0.2172	61 42	38 40	7 46
258. Tyche	2.5643	1499.8	0.1966	15 42	208 4	14 50
134. Sophrosyne	2.5647	1500.3	0.1165	67 33	346 22	11 36
264. Libussa	2.5672	1502.4	0.0925	0 7	50 23	10 29
193. Ambrosia	2.5758	1510.0	0.2854	70 52	351 15	11 39
13. Egeria	2.5765	1510.6	0.0871	120 10	43 12	16 32
5. Astræa	2.5786	1512.4	0.1863	134 57	141 28	5 19
119. Althea	2.5824	1515.7	0.0815	11 29	203 57	5 45
157. Dejanira	2.5828	1516.1	0.2105	107 24	62 31	12 2
101. Helena	2.5849	1518.0	0.1386	327 15	343 46	10 11

32. Pomona	2.5873	1520.1	0.0830	193 22	220 43	5 29
91. Ægina	2.5895	1522.1	0.1087	80 22	11 7	2 8
14. Irene	2.5896	1522.1	0.1627	180 19	86 48	9 8
111. Ate	2.5927	1524.8	0.1053	108 42	306 13	4 57
151. Abundantia	2.5932	1525.3	0.0356	173 55	38 48	6 30
56. Melete	2.6010	1532.2	0.2340	294 50	194 1	8 2
132. Æthra	2.6025	1533.5	0.3799	152 24	260 2	25 0
214. Aschera	2.6111	1541.1	0.0316	115 55	342 30	3 27
70. Panoepa	2.6139	1543.6	0.1826	299 49	48 18	11 38
194. Procne	2.6159	1545.4	0.2383	319 33	159 19	18 24
53. Calypso	2.6175	1546.8	0.2060	92 52	143 58	5 7
78. Diana	2.6194	1548.5	0.2088	121 42	333 58	8 40
124. Alceste	2.6297	1557.6	0.0784	245 42	188 26	2 56

23. Thalia	2.6306	1558.4	0.2299	123 58	67 45	10 14
164. Eva	2.6314	1559.1	0.3471	359 32	77 28	24 25
15. Eunomia	2.6437	1570.0	0.1872	27 52	188 26	2 56
37. Fides	2.6440	1570.3	0.1758	66 26	8 21	3 7
66. Maia	2.6454	1571.6	0.1750	48 8	8 17	3 6
224. Oceana	2.6465	1572.6	0.0455	270 51	353 18	5 52
253. Mathilde	2.6469	1572.9	0.2620	333 39	180 3	6 37
50. Virginia	2.6520	1577.4	0.2852	10 9	173 45	2 48
144. Vibia	2.6530	1578.4	0.2348	7 9	76 47	4 48
85. Io	2.6539	1579.2	0.1911	322 35	203 56	11 53
26. Proserpine	2.6561	1581.1	0.0873	236 25	45 55	3 36
233. Asterope	2.6596	1584.3	0.1010	344 36	222 25	7 39
102. Miriam	2.6619	1586.3	0.3035	354 39	211 58	5 4

240. Vanadis	2.6638	1588.0	0.2056	51 53	114 54	2 6
73. Clytie	2.6652	1589.3	0.0419	57 55	7 51	2 24
218. Bianca	2.6653	1589.3	0.1155	230 14	170 50	15 13
141. Lumen	2.6666	1590.5	0.2115	13 43	319 7	11 57
77. Frigga	2.6680	1591.8	0.1318	58 47	2 0	2 28
3. Juno	2.6683	1592.0	0.2579	54 50	170 53	13 1
97. Clotho	2.6708	1594.3	0.2550	65 32	160 37	11 46
75. Eurydice	2.6720	1595.3	0.3060	335 33	359 56	5 1
145. Adeona	2.6724	1595.4	0.1406	117 53	77 41	12 38
204. Callisto	2.6732	1596.4	0.1752	257 45	205 40	8 19
114. Cassandra	2.6758	1598.8	0.1401	153 6	164 24	4 55
201. Penelope	2.6764	1599.3	0.1818	334 21	157 5	5 44
64. Angelina	2.6816	1603.9	0.1271	125 36	311 4	1 19

98. Ianthe	2.6847	1606.7	0.1920	148 52	354 7	15 32
34. Circe	2.6864	1608.3	0.1073	148 41	184 46	5 27
123. Brunhilda	2.6918	1613.2	0.1150	72 57	308 28	6 27
166. Rhodope	2.6927	1613.9	0.2140	30 51	129 33	12 2
109. Felicitas	2.6950	1616.0	0.3002	56 1	4 56	8 3
246. Asporina	2.6994	1619.9	0.1065	255 54	162 35	15 39
58. Concordia	2.7004	1620.8	0.0426	189 10	161 20	5 2
103. Hera	2.7014	1621.8	0.0803	321 3	136 18	5 24
54. Alexandra	2.7095	1629.1	0.2000	295 39	313 45	11 47
226. Weringia	2.7118	1631.2	0.2048	284 46	135 18	15 50
59. Olympia	2.7124	1631.7	0.1189	17 33	170 26	8 37
146. Lucina	2.7189	1637.5	0.0655	227 34	84 16	13 6
45. Eugenia	2.7205	1639.0	0.0811	232 5	147 57	6 35

210. Isabella	2.7235	1641.7	0.1220	44 22	32 58	5 18
187. Lamberta	2.7272	1645.0	0.2391	214 4	22 13	10 43
180. Garumna	2.7286	1646.3	0.1722	125 56	314 42	0 54
160. Una	2.7287	1646.4	0.0624	55 57	9 22	3 51
140. Siwa	2.7316	1649.0	0.2160	300 33	107 2	3 12
110. Lydia	2.7327	1650.0	0.0770	336 49	57 10	6 0
185. Eunice	2.7372	1654.1	0.1292	16 32	153 50	23 17
203. Pompeia	2.7376	1654.5	0.0588	42 51	348 37	3 13
200. Dynamene	2.7378	1654.6	0.1335	46 38	325 26	6 56
197. Arete	2.7390	1655.8	0.1621	324 51	82 6	8 48
206. Hersilia	2.7399	1656.5	0.0389	95 44	145 16	3 46
255. Oppavia	2.7402	1656.6	0.0728	169 15	14 6	9 33
247. Eukrate	2.7412	1657.7	0.2387	53 44	0 20	25 7

38. Leda	2.7432	1659.6	0.1531	101 20	296 27	6 57
125. Liberatrix	2.7437	1660.0	0.0798	273 29	169 35	4 38
173. Ino	2.7446	1660.8	0.2047	13 28	148 34	14 15
36. Atalanta	2.7452	1661.3	0.3023	42 44	359 14	18 42
128. Nemesis	2.7514	1666.9	0.1257	16 34	76 31	6 16
93. Minerva	2.7537	1669.0	0.1405	274 44	5 4	8 37
127. Johanna	2.7550	1670.3	0.0659	122 37	31 46	8 17
71. Niobe	2.7558	1671.0	0.1732	221 17	316 30	23 19
213. Lilæa	2.7563	1671.4	0.1437	281 4	122 17	6 47
55. Pandora	2.7604	1675.1	0.1429	10 36	10 56	7 14
237. Cœlestina	2.7607	1675.5	0.0738	282 49	84 33	9 46
143. Adria	2.7619	1676.6	0.0729	222 27	333 42	11 30
82. Alcmene	2.7620	1676.6	0.2228	131 45	26 57	2 51

116. Sirona	2.7669	1681.1	0.1433	152 47	64 26	3 35
1. Ceres	2.7673	1681.4	0.0763	149 38	80 47	10 37
88. Thisbe	2.7673	1681.5	0.1632	308 34	277 54	16 11
215. Ænone	2.7679	1682.0	0.0390	346 24	25 25	1 44
2. Pallas	2.7680	1682.1	0.2408	122 12	172 45	34 44
39. Lætitia	2.7680	1682.1	0.1142	3 8	157 15	10 22
41. Daphne	2.7688	1682.8	0.2674	220 33	179 8	15 58
177. Irma	2.7695	1683.5	0.2370	22 6	349 17	1 27
148. Gallia	2.7710	1684.8	0.1855	36 7	145 13	25 21
267. Tirza	2.7742	1687.6	0.0986	264 5	73 59	6 2
74. Galatea	2.7770	1690.3	0.2392	8 18	197 51	4 0
205. Martha	2.7771	1690.4	0.1752	21 54	212 12	10 40
139. Juëwa	2.7793	1692.4	0.1773	164 34	2 21	10 57

28. Bellona	2.7797	1692.7	0.1491	124 1	144 37	9 22
68. Leto	2.7805	1693.5	0.1883	345 14	45 1	7 58
216. Cleopatra	2.7964	1708.0	0.2492	328 15	215 49	13 2
99. Dike	2.7966	1708.3	0.2384	240 36	41 44	13 53
236. Honorio	2.7993	1710.7	0.1893	356 59	186 27	7 37
183. Istria	2.8024	1713.4	0.3530	45 0	142 46	26 33
266. Aline	2.8078	1718.5	0.1573	23 52	236 18	13 20
188. Menippe	2.8211	1730.7	0.2173	309 38	241 44	11 21
167. Urda	2.8533	1760.4	0.0340	296 4	166 28	2 11
81. Terpsichore	2.8580	1764.8	0.2080	49 1	2 25	7 55
174. Phædra	2.8600	1766.6	0.1492	253 12	328 49	12 9
243. Ida	2.8610	1767.5	0.0419	71 22	326 21	1 10
242. Kriemhild	2.8623	1768.7	0.1219	123 1	207 57	11 17

129. Antigone	2.8678	1773.9	0.2126	242 4	137 37	12 10
217. Eudora	2.8690	1774.9	0.3068	314 41	164 10	10 19
158. Coronis	2.8714	1777.2	0.0545	56 56	281 30	1 0
33. Polyhymnia	2.8751	1780.7	0.3349	342 59	9 19	1 56
195. Euryclea	2.8790	1784.2	0.0471	115 48	7 57	7 1
235. Caroline	2.8795	1784.7	0.0595	268 29	66 35	9 4
47. Aglaia	2.8819	1786.9	0.1317	312 40	40 20	5 1
208. Lachrymosa	2.8926	1796.9	0.0149	127 52	5 43	1 48
191. Kolga	2.8967	1800.8	0.0876	23 21	159 47	11 29
22. Calliope	2.9090	1801.0	0.0193	62 43	4 47	1 45
155. Scylla	2.9127	1815.7	0.2559	82 1	42 52	14 4
238. Hypatia	2.9163	1819.0	0.0946	32 18	184 26	12 28
231. Vindobona	2.9192	1821.7	0.1537	253 23	352 49	5 10

16. Psyche	2.9210	1823.4	0.1392	15 9	150 36	3 4
179. Clytemnestra	2.9711	1870.6	0.1133	355 39	253 13	7 47
239. Adrastea	2.9736	1873.0	0.2279	26 1	181 34	6 4
69. Hesperia	2.9779	1877.0	0.1712	108 19	187 12	8 28
150. Nuwa	2.9785	1877.5	0.1307	355 27	207 35	2 9
61. Danaë	2.9855	1884.2	0.1615	344 4	334 11	18 14
117. Lomia	2.9907	1889.1	0.0229	48 46	349 39	14 58
35. Leucothea	2.9923	1890.6	0.2237	202 25	355 49	8 12
263. Dresda	3.0120	1909.3	0.3051	308 49	217 56	1 27
221. Eos	3.0134	1910.7	0.1028	330 58	142 35	10 51
162. Laurentia	3.0241	1920.8	0.1726	145 52	38 15	6 4
156. Xantippe	3.0375	1933.7	0.2637	155 58	246 11	7 29
241. Germania	3.0381	1934.0	0.1013	340 7	272 28	5 30

256. Walpurga	3.0450	1940.8	0.1180	240 17	183 35	12 44
211. Isolda	3.0464	1942.2	0.1541	74 12	265 29	3 51
96. Ægle	3.0497	1945.3	0.1405	163 10	322 50	16 7
257. Silesia	3.0572	1952.5	0.2555	54 16	34 31	4 41
133. Cyrene	3.0578	1953.0	0.1398	247 13	321 8	7 14
95. Arethusa	3.0712	1965.9	0.1447	32 58	244 17	12 54
202. Chryseis	3.0777	1972.1	0.0959	129 46	137 47	8 48
268. ———	3.0852	1973.9	0.1285	184 48	121 53	2 25
100. Hecate	3.0904	1984.3	0.1639	308 3	128 12	6 23
49. Pales	3.0908	1984.7	0.2330	31 15	290 40	3 8
223. Rosa	3.0940	1987.9	0.1186	102 48	49 0	1 59
52. Europa	3.0955	1988.0	0.1098	106 57	129 40	7 27
245. Vera	3.0985	1992.1	0.1950	25 29	62 37	5 10

86. Semele	3.1015	1995.1	0.2193	29 10	87 45	4 47
159. Æmilia	3.1089	2002.2	0.1034	101 22	135 9	6 4
48. Doris	3.1127	2005.9	0.0649	70 33	184 55	6 31
196. Philomela	3.1137	2006.8	0.0118	309 19	73 24	7 16
130. Electra	3.1145	2007.7	0.2132	20 34	146 6	22 57
212. Medea	3.1157	2008.8	0.1013	56 18	315 16	4 16
120. Lachesis	3.1211	2014.0	0.0475	214 0	342 51	7 1
181. Eucharis	3.1226	2015.4	0.2205	95 25	144 45	18 38
62. Erato	3.1241	2016.9	0.1756	39 0	125 46	2 12
222. Lucia	3.1263	2019.0	0.1453	258 2	80 11	2 11
137. Melibœa	3.1264	2019.1	0.2074	307 58	204 22	13 22
165. Loreley	3.1269	2019.6	0.0734	223 50	304 6	10 12
251. Sophia	3.1315	2024.1	0.1243	77 7	157 6	10 20

24. Themis	3.1357	2028.1	0.1242	144 8	35 49	0 49
152. Atala	3.1362	2028.6	0.0862	84 23	41 29	12 12
10. Hygeia	3.1366	2029.1	0.1156	237 2	285 38	3 49
259. Aletheia	3.1369	2029.3	0.1176	241 45	88 32	10 40
227. Philosophia	3.1393	2031.6	0.2131	226 23	330 52	9 16
147. Protogenea	3.1393	2031.6	0.0247	25 38	251 16	1 54
171. Ophelia	3.1432	2035.4	0.1168	143 59	101 10	2 34
209. Dido	3.1436	2035.9	0.0637	257 33	2 0	7 15
31. Euphrosyne	3.1468	2039.0	0.2228	93 26	31 31	26 27
90. Antiope	3.1475	2039.7	0.1645	301 15	71 29	2 17
104. Clymene	3.1507	2042.7	0.1579	59 32	43 32	2 54
57. Mnemosyne	3.1510	2043.0	0.1145	53 25	200 2	15 12
250. Bettina	3.1524	2044.3	0.1302	87 28	26 12	12 54

252. Clementina	3.1552	2047.1	0.0837	355 8	208 19	10 2
94. Aurora	3.1602	2052.0	0.0827	48 46	4 9	8 4
106. Dione	3.1670	2058.6	0.1788	25 57	63 14	4 38
199. Byblis	3.1777	2069.0	0.1687	261 20	89 52	15 22
92. Undina	3.1851	2076.3	0.1024	331 27	102 52	9 57
184. Deiopea	3.1883	2079.4	0.0725	169 22	336 18	1 12
176. Idunna	3.1906	2081.6	0.1641	20 34	201 13	22 31
154. Bertha	3.1976	2088.5	0.0788	190 47	37 35	20 59
108. Hecuba	3.2113	2101.0	0.1005	173 49	352 17	4 24
122. Gerda	3.2177	2108.2	0.0415	203 45	178 43	1 36
168. Sibylla	3.3765	2266.2	0.0707	11 26	209 47	4 33
225. Henrietta	3.4007	2277.8	0.2661	299 13	200 45	20 45
229. Adelinda	3.4129	2302.9	0.1562	332 7	30 49	2 11

76. Freia	3.4140	2304.1	0.1700	90 49	212 5	2 3
260. Huberta	3.4212	2311.5	0.1113	313 22	168 48	6 18
65. Maximiliana	3.4270	2317.2	0.1097	260 36	158 50	3 29
121. Hermione	3.4535	2344.2	0.1255	357 50	76 46	7 36
87. Sylvia	3.4833	2374.5	0.0922	333 48	75 49	10 55
107. Camilla	3.4847	2376.0	0.0756	115 53	176 18	9 54
175. Andromache	3.5071	2399.0	0.3476	293 0	23 35	3 46
190. Ismene	3.9471	2864.3	0.1634	105 39	177 0	6 7
153. Hilda	3.9523	2869.9	0.1721	285 47	228 20	7 55

PART II.

DISCUSSION OF THE FACTS IN TABLE II.

1. Extent of the Zone.

In Table II. the unit of column *a* is the earth's mean distance from the sun, or ninety-three million miles. On this scale the breadth of the zone is 1.8196. Or, if we estimate the breadth from the perihelion of *Æthra* (1.612) to the aphelion of *Andromache* (4.726), it is 3.114,—more than three times the radius of the earth's orbit. A very remarkable characteristic of the group is the interlacing or intertwining of orbits. "One fact," says D'Arrest, "seems above all to confirm the idea of an intimate relation between all the minor planets; it is, that if their orbits are figured under the form of material rings, these rings will be found so entangled that it would be possible, by means of one among them taken at hazard, to lift up all the rest."^[6] Our present knowledge of this wide and complicated cluster is the result of a vast amount, not only of observations, but also of mathematical labor. In view, however, of the perturbations of these bodies by the larger planets, and especially by Jupiter, it is easy to see that the discussion of their motions must present a field of investigation practically boundless.

While the known minor planets were but few in number the theory of Olbers in regard to their origin seemed highly probable; it has, however, been completely disproved by more recent discoveries. The breadth of the zone being now greater than the distance of Mars from the sun, it is no more probable that the asteroids were produced by the disruption of a single planet than that Mercury, Venus, the earth, and Mars originated in a similar manner.

2. The Small Mass of the Asteroids.

In taking a general view of the solar system we cannot fail to be struck by the remarkable fact that Jupiter, whose mass is much greater than that of all other planets united, should be immediately succeeded by a region so nearly destitute of matter as the zone of asteroids. Leverrier inferred from the motion of Mars's perihelion that the mass of Jupiter is at least twelve

hundred times greater than that of all the planets in the asteroid ring. The fact is suggestive of Jupiter's dominating energy in the evolution of the asteroid system. We find also something analogous among the satellites of Jupiter, Saturn, and Uranus. Jupiter's third satellite, the largest of the number, is nearly four times greater than the second. Immediately within the orbit of Titan, the largest satellite of Saturn, occurs a wide hiatus, and the volume of the next interior satellite is to that of Titan in the ratio of one to twenty-one. In the Uranian system the widest interval between adjacent orbits is just within the orbit of the bright satellite, Titania.

The foregoing facts suggest the inquiry, What effect would be produced by a large planet on interior masses abandoned by a central spheroid? As the phenomena in all instances would be of the same nature, we will consider a single case,—that of Jupiter and the asteroids.

The powerful mass of the exterior body would produce great perturbations of the neighboring small planets abandoned at the solar equator. The disturbed orbits, in some cases, would thus attain considerable eccentricity, so that the matter moving in them would, in perihelion, be brought in contact with the equatorial parts of the central body, and thus become reunited with it.^[7] The extreme rarity of the zone between Mars and Jupiter, regarded as a single ring, is thus accounted for in accordance with known dynamical laws.

3. The Limits of Perihelion Distance.

It is sufficiently obvious that whenever the perihelion distance of a planet or comet is less than the sun's radius, a collision must occur as the moving body approaches the focus of its path. The great comet of 1843 passed so near the sun as almost to graze its surface. With a perihelion distance but very slightly less, it would have been precipitated into the sun and incorporated with its mass. In former epochs, when the dimensions of the sun were much greater than at present, this falling of comets into the central orb of the system must have been a comparatively frequent occurrence. Again, if Mercury's orbit had its present eccentricity when the radius of the solar spheroid was twenty-nine million miles, the planet at its nearest approach to the centre of its motion must have passed through the outer strata of the central body. In such case a lessening of the planet's mean

distance would be a necessary consequence. We thus see that in the formation of the solar system the eccentricity of an asteroidal orbit could not increase beyond a moderate limit without the planet's return to the solar mass. The bearing of these views on the arrangement of the minor planets will appear in what follows.

4. Was the Asteroid Zone originally Stable?—Distribution of the Members in Space.

One of the most interesting discoveries of the eighteenth century was Lagrange's law securing the stability of the solar system. This celebrated theorem, however, is not to be understood in an absolute or unlimited sense. It makes no provision against the effect of a resisting medium, or against the entrance of cosmic matter from without. It does not secure the stability of all periodic comets nor of the meteor streams revolving about the sun. In the early stages of the system's development the matter moving in unstable orbits may have been, and probably was, much more abundant than at present. But even now, are we justified in concluding that all known asteroids have stable orbits? For the major planets the secular variations of eccentricity have been calculated, but for the orbits between Mars and Jupiter these limits are unknown. With an eccentricity of 0.252 (less than that of many asteroids), the distance of Hilda's aphelion would be greater than that of Jupiter's perihelion. It seems possible, therefore, that certain minor planets may have their orbits much changed by Jupiter's disturbing influence.^[8]

Whoever looks at a table of asteroids arranged in their order of discovery will find only a perplexing mass of figures. Whether we regard their distances, their inclinations, or the forms of their orbits, the elements of the members are without any obvious connection. Nor is the confusion lessened when the orbits are drawn and presented to the eye. In fact, the crossing and recrossing of so many ellipses of various forms merely increase the entanglement. But can no order be traced in all this complexity? Are there no breaks or vacant spaces within the zone's extreme limits? Has Jupiter's influence been effective in fixing the position and arrangement of the cluster? Such are some of the questions demanding our attention. If "the

universe is a book written for man's reading," patient study may resolve the problem contained in these mysterious leaves.

Simultaneously with the discovery of new members in the cluster of minor planets, near the middle of the century, occurred the resolution of the great nebula in Orion. This startling achievement by Lord Rosse's telescope was the signal for the abandonment of the nebular hypothesis by many of its former advocates. To the present writer, however, the partial resolution of a single nebula seemed hardly a sufficient reason for its summary rejection. The question then arose whether any probable test of Laplace's theory could be found in the solar system itself. The train of thought was somewhat as follows: Several new members have been found in the zone of asteroids; its dimensions have been greatly extended, so that we can now assign no definite limits either to the ring itself or to the number of its planets; if the nebular hypothesis be true, the sun, after Jupiter's separation, extended successively to the various decreasing distances of the several asteroids; the eccentricities of these bodies are generally greater than those of the old planets; this difference is probably due to the disturbing force of Jupiter; the zone includes several distances at which the periods of asteroids would be commensurable with that of Jupiter; in such case the conjunctions of the minor with the major planet would occur in the same parts of its path, the disturbing effects would accumulate, and the eccentricity would become very marked; such bodies in perihelion would return to the sun, and hence blanks or chasms would be formed in particular parts of the zone. On the other hand, if the nebular hypothesis was not true, the occurrence of these gaps was not to be expected. Having thus pointed out a prospective test of the theory, it was announced with some hesitation that *those parts of the asteroid zone in which a simple relation of commensurability would obtain between the period of a minor planet and that of Jupiter are distinguished as gaps or chasms similar to the interval in Saturn's ring.*

The existence of these blanks was thus predicted in theory before it was established as a fact of observation. When the law was first publicly stated in 1866, but ten asteroids had been found with distances greater than three times that of the earth. The number of such now known is sixty-five. For more than a score of years the progress of discovery has been watched with lively interest, and the one hundred and eighty new members of the group have been found moving in harmony with this law of distribution.^[9]

COMMENSURABILITY OF PERIODS.

When we say that an asteroid's period is commensurable with that of Jupiter, we mean that a certain whole number of the former is equal to another whole number of the latter. For instance, if a minor planet completes two revolutions to Jupiter's one, or five to Jupiter's two, the periods are commensurable. It must be remarked, however, that Jupiter's effectiveness in disturbing the motion of a minor planet depends on the *order* of commensurability. Thus, if the ratio of the less to the greater period is expressed by the fraction $\frac{1}{2}$, where the difference between the numerator and the denominator is one, the commensurability is of the first order; $\frac{1}{3}$ is of the second; $\frac{2}{5}$, of the third, etc. The difference between the terms of the ratio indicates the frequency of conjunctions while Jupiter is completing the number of revolutions expressed by the numerator. The distance 3.277, corresponding to the ratio $\frac{1}{2}$, is the only case of the first order in the entire ring; those of the second order, answering to $\frac{1}{3}$ and $\frac{3}{5}$, are 2.50 and 3.70. These orders of commensurability may be thus arranged in a tabular form, the radius of the earth's orbit being the unit of distance:

Order.	Ratio.	Distance.
First	$\frac{1}{2}$	3.277
Second	$\frac{1}{3}, \frac{3}{5}$	$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} 2.50 \\ 3.70 \end{array} \right.$
Third	$\frac{2}{5}, \frac{4}{7}, \frac{5}{8}$	$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} 2.82 \\ 3.58 \\ 3.80 \end{array} \right.$
Fourth	$\frac{3}{7}, \frac{5}{9}, \frac{7}{11}$	$\left\{ \begin{array}{l} 2.95 \\ 3.51 \\ 3.85 \end{array} \right.$

Do these parts of the ring present discontinuities? and, if so, can they be ascribed to a chance distribution? Let us consider them in order.

I.—The Distance 3.277.

At this distance an asteroid's conjunctions with Jupiter would all occur at the same place, and its perturbations would be there repeated at intervals equal to Jupiter's period (11.86 y.). Now, when the asteroids are arranged in the order of their mean distances (as in Table II.) this part of the zone presents a wide chasm. The space between 3.218 and 3.376 remains, hitherto a perfect blank, while the adjacent portions of equal breadth, interior and exterior, contain fifty-four minor planets. The probability that this distribution is not the result of chance is more than three hundred billions to one.

The breadth of this chasm is one-twentieth part of its distance from the sun, or one-eleventh part of the breadth of the entire zone.

II.—The Second Order of Commensurability.—The Distances 2.50 and 3.70.

At the former of these distances an asteroid's period would be one-third of Jupiter's, and at the latter, three-fifths. That part of the zone included between the distances 2.30 and 2.70 contains one hundred and ten intervals, exclusive of the maximum at the critical distance 2.50. This gap—between Thetis and Hestia—is not only much greater than any other of this number, but is more than sixteen times greater than their average. The distance 3.70 falls in the wide hiatus interior to the orbit of Ismene.

III.—Chasms corresponding to the Third Order.—The Distances 2.82, 3.58, and 3.80.

As the order of commensurability becomes less simple, the corresponding breaks in the zone are less distinctly marked. In the present case conjunctions with Jupiter would occur at angular intervals of 120° . The gaps, however, are still easily perceptible. Between the distances 2.765 and 2.808 we find twenty minor planets. In the next exterior space of equal breadth, containing the distance 2.82, there is but one. This is No. 188, Menippe, whose elements are still somewhat uncertain. The space between 2.851 and 2.894—that is, the part of equal extent immediately beyond the

gap—contains thirteen asteroids. The distances 3.58 and 3.80 are in the chasm between Andromache and Ismene.

IV.—The Distances 2.95, 3.51, [\[10\]](#) and 3.85, corresponding to the Fourth Order of Commensurability.

The first of these distances is in the interval between Psyche and Clytemnestra; the second and third, in that exterior to Andromache.

The nine cases considered are the only ones in which the conjunctions with Jupiter would occur at less than five points of an asteroid's orbit. Higher orders of commensurability may perhaps be neglected. It will be seen, however, that the distances 2.25, 2.70, 3.03, and 3.23, corresponding to the ratios of the fifth order, $\frac{2}{7}$, $\frac{3}{8}$, $\frac{4}{9}$, and $\frac{6}{11}$, still afford traces of Jupiter's influence. The first is in the interval between Augusta and Feronia; the last falls in the same gap with 3.277; and the second and third are in breaks less distinctly marked. It may also be worthy of notice that the rather wide interval between Prymno and Victoria is where ten periods of a minor planet would be equal to three of Jupiter. The distance of Medusa is somewhat uncertain.

The FACT of the existence of well-defined gaps in the designated parts of the ring has been clearly established. But the theory of probability applied in a single instance gives, as we have seen, but one chance in 300,000,000,000 that the distribution is accidental. This improbability is increased many millions of times when we include all the gaps corresponding to simple cases of commensurability. We conclude, therefore, that those discontinuities cannot be referred to a chance arrangement. What, then, was their physical cause? and what has become of the eliminated asteroids?

What was said in regard to the limits of perihelion distance may suggest a possible answer to these interesting questions. The doctrine of the sun's gradual contraction is now accepted by a majority of astronomers. According to this theory the solar radius at an epoch not relatively remote was twice what it is at present. At anterior stages it was 0.4, 1.0, 2.0, [\[11\]](#) etc. At the first mentioned the comets of 1843 and 1668, as well as several others, could not have been moving in their present orbits, since in perihelion they must have plunged into the sun. At the second, Encke's

comet and all others with perihelia within Mercury's orbit would have shared a similar fate. At the last named all asteroids with perihelion distances less than two would have been re-incorporated with the central mass. As the least distance of *Æthra* is but 1.587, its orbit could not have had its present form and dimensions when the radius of the solar nebula was equal to the aphelion distance of Mars (1.665).

It is easy to see, therefore, that in those parts of the ring where Jupiter would produce extraordinary disturbance the formation of chasms would be very highly probable.

5. Relations between certain Adjacent Orbits.

The distances, periods, inclinations, and eccentricities of Hilda and Ismene, the outermost pair of the group, are very nearly identical. It is a remarkable fact, however, that the longitudes of their perihelia differ by almost exactly 180° . Did they separate at nearly the same time from opposite sides of the solar nebula? Other adjacent pairs having a striking similarity between their orbital elements are Sirona and Ceres, Fides and Maia, Fortuna and Eurynome, and perhaps a few others. Such coincidences can hardly be accidental. Original asteroids, soon after their detachment from the central body, may have been separated by the sun's unequal attraction on their parts. Such divisions have occurred in the world of comets, why not also in the cluster of minor planets?

6. The Eccentricities.

The least eccentric orbit in the group is that of *Philomela* (196); the most eccentric that of *Æthra* (132). Comparing these with the orbit of the second comet of 1867 we have

The eccentricity of	Philomela = 0.01
" " "	<i>Æthra</i> = 0.38
" " "	Comet II. 1867 (ret. in 1885) = 0.41

The orbit of *Æthra*, it is seen, more nearly resembles the last than the first. It might perhaps be called the connecting-link between planetary and cometary orbits.

The average eccentricity of the two hundred and sixty-eight asteroids whose orbits have been calculated is 0.1569. As with the orbits of the old planets, the eccentricities vary within moderate limits, some increasing, others diminishing. The average, however, will probably remain very nearly the same. An inspection of the table shows that while but one orbit is less eccentric than the earth's, sixty-nine depart more from the circular form than the orbit of Mercury. These eccentricities seem to indicate that the forms of the asteroidal orbits were influenced by special causes. It may be worthy of remark that the eccentricity does not appear to vary with the distance from the sun, being nearly the same for the interior members of the zone as for the exterior.

7. The Inclinations.

The inclinations in Table II. are thus distributed:

From	0° to 4°	70
"	4° to 8°	83
"	8° to 12°	59
"	12° to 16°	32
"	16° to 20°	8
"	20° to 24°	8
"	24° to 28°	7
"	28° to 32°	0
	above 32°	1

One hundred and fifty-four, considerably more than half, have inclinations between 3° and 11°, and the mean of the whole number is about 8°,—slightly greater than the inclination of Mercury, or that of the plane of the sun's equator. The smallest inclination, that of Massalia, is 0° 41′, and the largest, that of Pallas, is about 35°. Sixteen minor planets, or six per cent. of the whole number, have inclinations exceeding 20°. Does any relation obtain between high inclinations and great eccentricities? These elements in the cases named above are as follows:

Asteroid.	Inclination.		Eccentricity.
Pallas	34°	42′	0.238
Istria	26	30	0.353
Euphrosyne	26	29	0.228
Anna	25	24	0.263
Gallia	25	21	0.185
Æthra	25	0	0.380
Eukrate	24	57	0.236
Eva	24	25	0.347
Niobe	23	19	0.173
Eunice	23	17	0.129
Electra	22	55	0.208
Idunna	22	31	0.164
Phoebe	21	35	0.255
Artemis	21	31	0.175
Bertha	20	59	0.085
Henrietta	20	47	0.260

This comparison shows the most inclined orbits to be also very eccentric; Bertha and Eunice being the only exceptions in the foregoing list. On the other hand, however, we find over fifty asteroids with eccentricities exceeding 0.20 whose inclinations are not extraordinary. The dependence of

the phenomena on a common cause can, therefore, hardly be admitted. At least, the forces which produced the great eccentricity failed in a majority of cases to cause high inclinations.

8. Longitudes of the Perihelia.

The perihelia of the asteroidal orbits are very unequally distributed; one hundred and thirty-six—a majority of the whole number determined—being within the 120° from longitude $290^\circ 50'$ to $59^\circ 50'$. The maximum occurs between 30° and 60° , where thirty-five perihelia are found in 30° of longitude.

9. Distribution of the Ascending Nodes.

An inspection of the column containing the longitudes of the ascending nodes, in Table II., indicates two well-marked maxima, each extending about sixty degrees, in opposite parts of the heavens.

I.	From 310° to 10° ,	containing	61	ascending	nodes.
II.	" 120° to 180° ,	"	59	"	"
	Making in 120°		<u>120</u>	"	"

A uniform distribution would give 89. An arc of 84° —from 46° to 130° —contains the ascending nodes of all the old planets. This arc, it will be noticed, is not coincident with either of the maxima found for the asteroids.

10. The Periods.

Since, according to Kepler's third law, the periods of planets depend upon their mean distances, the clustering tendency found in the latter must obtain also in the former. This marked irregularity in the order of periods is seen below.

Between	1100	and	1200	days	6	periods.
"	1200	"	1300	"	7	"
"	1300	"	1400	"	43	"
"	1400	"	1500	"	13	"

"	1500	"	1600	"	46	"
"	1600	"	1700	"	54	"
"	1700	"	1800	"	20	"
"	1800	"	1900	"	13	"
"	1900	"	2000	"	19	"
"	2000	"	2100	"	33	"
"	2100	"	2200	"	2	"
"	2200	"	2300	"	2	"
"	2300	"	2400	"	8	"
"	2400	"	2800	"	0	"
"	2800	"	2900	"	2	"

The period of Hilda (153) is more than two and a half times that of Medusa (149). This is greater than the ratio of Saturn's period to that of Jupiter. The maximum observed between 2000 and 2100 days corresponds to the space immediately interior to chasm I. on a previous page, that between 1300 and 1400 to the space interior to the second, and that between 1500 and 1700 to the part of the zone within the fourth gap. The table presents quite numerous instances of approximate equality; in forty-three cases the periods differing less than twenty-four hours. It is impossible to say, however, whether any two of these periods are *exactly* equal. In cases of a very close approach two asteroids, notwithstanding their small mass, may exert upon each other quite sensible perturbations.

11. Origin of the Asteroids.

But four minor planets had been discovered when Laplace issued his last edition of the "Système du Monde." The author, in his celebrated seventh note in the second volume of that work, explained the origin of these bodies by assuming that the primitive ring from which they were formed, instead of collecting into a single sphere, as in the case of the major planets, broke up into four distinct masses. But the form and extent of the cluster as now known, as well as the observed facts bearing on the constitution of Saturn's ring, seem to require a modification of Laplace's theory. Throughout the greater part of the interval between Mars and Jupiter an almost continuous succession of small planetary masses—not nebulous rings—appears to have

been abandoned at the solar equator. The entire cluster, distributed throughout a space whose outer radius exceeds the inner by more than two hundred millions of miles, could not have originated, as supposed by Laplace, in a single nebulous zone the different parts of which revolved with the same angular velocity. The following considerations may furnish a suggestion in regard to the mode in which these bodies were separated from the equator of the solar nebula.

(a) The perihelion distance of Jupiter is 4.950, while the aphelion distance of Hilda is 4.623. If, therefore, the sun once extended to the latter, the central attraction of its mass on an equatorial particle was but five times greater than Jupiter's perihelion influence on the same. It is easy to see, then, that this "giant planet" would produce enormous tidal elevations in the solar mass.

(b) The centrifugal force would be greatest at the crest of this tidal wave.

(c) Three periods of solar revolution were then about equal to two periods of Jupiter. The disturbing influence of the planet would therefore be increased at each conjunction with this protuberance. The ultimate separation (not of a ring but) of a planetary mass would be the probable result of these combined and accumulating forces.

12. Variability of Certain Asteroids.

Observations of some minor planets have indicated a variation of their apparent magnitudes. Frigga, discovered by Dr. Peters in 1862, was observed at the next opposition in 1864; but after this it could not be found till 1868, when it was picked up by Professor Tietjen. From the latter date its light seems again to have diminished, as all efforts to re-observe it were unsuccessful till 1879. According to Dr. Peters, the change in brightness during the period of observation in that year was greater than that due to its varying distance. No explanation of such changes has yet been offered. It has been justly remarked, however, that "the length of the period of the fluctuation does not allow of our connecting it with the rotation of the planet."

13. The Average Asteroid Orbit.

At the meeting of the American Association for the Advancement of Science in 1884, Professor Mark W. Harrington, of Ann Arbor, Michigan, presented a paper in which the elements of the asteroid system were considered on the principle of averages. Two hundred and thirty orbits, all that had then been determined, were employed in the discussion. Professor Harrington supposes two planes to intersect the ecliptic at right angles; one passing through the equinoxes and the other through the solstices. These planes will intersect the asteroidal orbits, each in four points, and "the mean intersection at each solstice and equinox may be considered a point in the average orbit."

In 1883 the Royal Academy of Denmark offered its gold medal for a statistical examination of the orbits of the small planets considered as parts of a ring around the sun. The prize was awarded in 1885 to M. Svedstrup, of Copenhagen. The results obtained by these astronomers severally are as follows:

	Harrington.	Svedstrup.
Longitude of perihelion	14° 39′	101° 48′
Longitude of ascending node	113 56	133 27
Inclination	1 0	6 6
Eccentricity	0.0448	0.0281
Mean distance	2.7010	2.6435

These elements, with the exception of the first, are in reasonable harmony.

14. The Relation of Short-Period Comets to the Zone of Asteroids.

Did comets originate within the solar system, or do they enter it from without? Laplace assigned them an extraneous origin, and his view is adopted by many eminent astronomers. With all due respect to the authority of great names, the present writer has not wholly abandoned the theory that

some comets of short period are specially related to the minor planets. According to M. Lehmann-Filhès, the eccentricity of the third comet of 1884, before its last close approach to Jupiter, was only 0.2787.^[12] This is exceeded by that of twelve known minor planets. Its mean distance before this great perturbation was about 4.61, and six of its periods were nearly equal to five of Jupiter's,—a commensurability of the first order. According to Hind and Krueger, the great transformation of its orbit by Jupiter's influence occurred in May, 1875. It had previously been an asteroid too remote to be seen even in perihelion. This body was discovered by M. Wolf, at Heidelberg, September 17, 1884. Its present period is about six and one-half years.

The perihelion distance of the comet 1867 II. at its return in 1885 was 2.073; its aphelion is 4.897; so that its entire path, like those of the asteroids, is included between the orbits of Mars and Jupiter. Its eccentricity, as we have seen, is little greater than that of *Æthra*, and its period, inclination, and longitude of the ascending node are approximately the same with those of *Sylvia*, the eighty-seventh minor planet. In short, this comet may be regarded as an asteroid whose elements have been considerably modified by perturbation.

It has been stated that the gap at the distance 3.277 is the only one corresponding to the first order of commensurability. The distance 3.9683, where an asteroid's period would be two-thirds of Jupiter's, is immediately beyond the outer limit of the cluster as at present known; the mean distance of *Hilda* being 3.9523. The discovery of new members beyond this limit is by no means improbable. Should a minor planet at the mean distance 3.9683 attain an eccentricity of 0.3—and this is less than that of eleven now known—its aphelion would be more remote than the perihelion of Jupiter. Such an orbit might not be stable. Its form and extent might be greatly changed after the manner of Lexell's comet. Two well-known comets, Faye's and Denning's, have periods approximately equal to two-thirds of Jupiter's. In like manner the periods of D'Arrest's and Biela's comets correspond to the hiatus at 3.51, and that of 1867 II. to that at 3.277.

Of the thirteen telescopic comets whose periods correspond to mean distances within the asteroid zone, all have direct motion; all have inclinations similar to those of the minor planets; and their eccentricities are

generally less than those of other known comets. Have these facts any significance in regard to their origin?

APPENDIX.

NOTE A.

THE POSSIBLE EXISTENCE OF ASTEROIDS IN UNDISCOVERED RINGS.

If Jupiter's influence was a factor in the separation of planetules at the sun's equator, may not similar clusters exist in other parts of our system? The hypothesis is certainly by no means improbable. For anything we know to the contrary a group may circulate between Jupiter and Saturn; such bodies, however, could not be discovered—at least not by ordinary telescopes—on account of their distance. The Zodiacal Light, it has been suggested, may be produced by a cloud of indefinitely small particles related to the planets between the sun and Mars. The rings of Saturn are merely a dense asteroidal cluster; and, finally, the phenomena of luminous meteors indicate the existence of small masses of matter moving with different velocities in interstellar space.

NOTE B.

THE ORIGIN AND STRUCTURE OF COSMICAL RINGS.

The general theory of cosmical rings and of their arrangement in sections or clusters with intervening chasms may be briefly stated in the following propositions:

I.

Whenever the separating force of a primary body on a secondary or satellite is greater than the central attraction of the latter on its superficial stratum, the satellite, if either gaseous or liquid, will be transformed into a ring.

EXAMPLES.—Saturn's ring, and the meteoric rings of April 20, August 10, November 14, and November 27.

See Payne's *Sidereal Messenger*, April, 1885.

II.

When a cosmical body is surrounded by a ring of considerable breadth, and has also exterior satellites at such distances that a simple relation of commensurability would obtain between the periods of these satellites and those of certain particles of the ring, the disturbing influence of the former will produce gaps or intervals in the ring so disturbed.

See "Meteoric Astronomy," Chapter XII.; also the *Proceedings of the American Philosophical Society*, October 6, 1871; and the *Sidereal Messenger* for February, 1884; where the papers referred to assign a physical cause for the gaps in Saturn's ring.

THE END.

FOOTNOTES:

[1] The discoverer, Piazzi, was not, as has been so often affirmed, one of the astronomers to whom the search had been especially committed.

[2] Massalia was discovered by De Gasparis, at Naples, Sept. 19, 1852, and independently, the next night, by Chacornac, at Marseilles. The name was given by the latter.

[3] Astr. Nach., No. 932.

[4] Monthly Notices, vol. xxvii.

[5] Annals of the Obs. of Harv. Coll., 1879.

[6] This ingenious idea may be readily extended. The least distance of *Æthra* is less than the present aphelion distance of Mars; and the maximum aphelion distance of the latter exceeds the perihelion distance of several known asteroids. Moreover, if we represent the orbits of the major planets, and also those of the comets of known periods, by material rings, it is easy to see that the major as well as the minor planets are all linked together in the manner suggested by D'Arrest.

[7] The effects of Jupiter's disturbing influence will again be resumed.

[8] Not only nebulae are probably unstable, but also many of the sidereal systems. The Milky Way itself was so regarded by Sir William Herschel.

[9] Menippe, No. 188, is placed in one of the gaps by its calculated elements; but the fact that it has not been seen since the year of its discovery, 1878, indicates a probable error in its elements.

[10] The minor planet *Andromache*, immediately interior to the critical distance 3.51, has elements somewhat remarkable. With two exceptions, *Æthra* (132) and *Istria* (183), it has the greatest eccentricity (0.3571),—nearly equal to that of the comet 1867 II. at its last return. Its perihelion distance is 2.2880, its aphelion 4.7262; hence the distance from the perihelion to the aphelion of its orbit is greater than its least distance from the sun, and it crosses the orbits of all members of the group so far as known; its least distance from the sun being considerably less than the aphelion of *Medusa*, and its greatest exceeding the aphelion of *Hilda*.

[11] The unit being the sun's distance from the earth.

[12] Annuaire, 1886.

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